EXPERIMENT ANALYSIS REPORT · 35% COMPONENT

SkinPact

FINAL PROJECT
2026-11-07
TESTNET ONLY

Testnet escrow for CS2 skin trades — gas economics, dispute design, and security boundaries

CONTRACT	NETWORK	CODE UNDER TEST	REPOSITORY
0x2Ffca056…460eF	Sepolia · 11155111	commit 6d8ffa0	github.com/identity411/dapps

11	1,173,272	$3,520	0
operations measured on local Hardhat and Sepolia	Sepolia happy-path gas (create + buy + mark + confirm)	break-even item price at a 1% fee (10 gwei, $3,000/ETH)	Slither High / Medium findings; 5 informational

00 Abstract

SkinPact is a testnet escrow marketplace for CS2 skins. It separates the item transfer inside Steam from the value transfer on-chain: the buyer funds escrow, the seller locks a bond, and the seller sends a Steam trade offer. The buyer can confirm receipt, the seller can claim delivery with off-chain evidence, and a designated arbiter settles disputes; the contract never claims to verify Steam. E1 measures all eleven state-changing operations on local Hardhat and Sepolia, compares gas with 1% / 2.5% / 5% platform fees, and derives break-even prices. E2 builds a 42-scenario threat model, runs 67 automated tests and a 99-check local E2E flow, and reports Slither and coverage results. The escrow design is coherent and no exploitable authorization, reentrancy, or double-settlement defect was found in the tested scope; the residual risks are L1 gas, Steam's unverifiability, the arbiter, and the buyer Trade URL. This is a testnet prototype, not a production marketplace.

01 Introduction

1.1 The problem

CS2 skins are valuable digital assets that live inside Steam, not on a public ledger. A trade is executed through a Steam trade offer: the seller selects the item, the buyer accepts in Steam Guard, and Steam transfers custody. The trade is asynchronous, off-chain, and irreversible once accepted. A buyer who pays first risks non-delivery; a seller who delivers first risks non-payment. Platform intermediaries reduce this risk but charge for it. The Steam Community Market charges a 15% seller fee for CS2 items (5% Steam transaction fee plus 10% game fee), and

the seller receives Steam Wallet balance rather than withdrawable cash. [1] Third-party markets such as BUFF163 and YouPin898 advertise lower seller fees — 1.5% and 1%, respectively, at the time of writing — but they still introduce custody, account, and platform-trust assumptions. [2][3]

The core design question is not “how do we remove fees?” A zero-fee marketplace that loses the item is worse than a 15% fee. The question is whether a smart-contract escrow can provide a credible settlement layer around an off-chain delivery rail, and what that costs.

1.2 Research questions

- **RQ1 — Cost.** How much gas does each SkinPact operation consume, and at what item price does gas become cheaper than a 1%, 2.5%, or 5% platform fee?
- **RQ2 — Trust.** Can the contract, Relay, and helper resist unauthorized calls, reentrancy, state bypasses, fake claims, and Trade URL leakage? Which trust assumptions remain?
- **RQ3 — Usability.** Can a new user understand the seller-helper and Steam-accept flow? We did not run a formal user study; this is treated as a disclosed limitation, not as evidence.

---

02 Background and Related Work

2.1 Steam delivery

A Steam trade offer is asynchronous and off-chain: the recipient accepts it in the Steam mobile app, and the trade is final once Steam processes it. Neither side can prove delivery or non-delivery to a smart contract, so an escrow can only record observations made by a trusted or semi-trusted component. This is SkinPact's central boundary.

2.2 Marketplace economics

Table 2 in §6.3 compares the rates used in this report. A *platform fee* scales with item price; L1 gas is roughly fixed per operation. For cheap skins, the fixed cost dominates. The experiment makes that trade-off visible rather than claiming that “zero fee” means “zero cost.”

2.3 Escrow, bonds, and pull payments

SkinPact uses an on-chain escrow, a seller bond of `max(price / 10, 0.001 ETH)`, pull payments, and a status machine that prevents settlement from a terminal state. The arbiter is the only privileged role; the contract has no owner, no emergency withdrawal, and no upgrade path. These choices move trust into the arbiter and the off-chain evidence process.

2.4 Market context

To ground the fee analysis in real listings, we sampled four CS2 items across price bands on the Steam Community Market on 2026-11-07. The sample spans a $21.79 pistol skin to a $479.83 rifle skin. These prices are market context; the on-chain experiments use a fixed 0.01 test ETH listing, not real money.

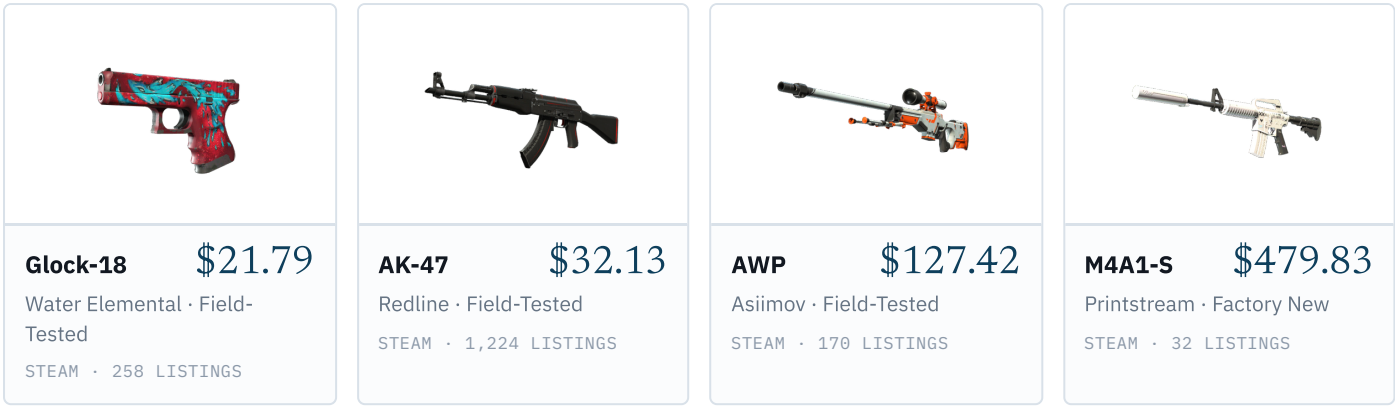


Figure 1. Four CS2 items sampled from the Steam Community Market on 2026-11-07. Prices are USD; listing counts are active sell listings. The sample is context, not a price survey; Steam prices move by region and time.

The delivery rail is Steam, but the competing marketplaces are not. Steam Community Market, BUFF163, and YouPin898 all list the same kind of item with different fee and custody models. The screenshots below are public pages, included to make the comparison concrete rather than to endorse a vendor.

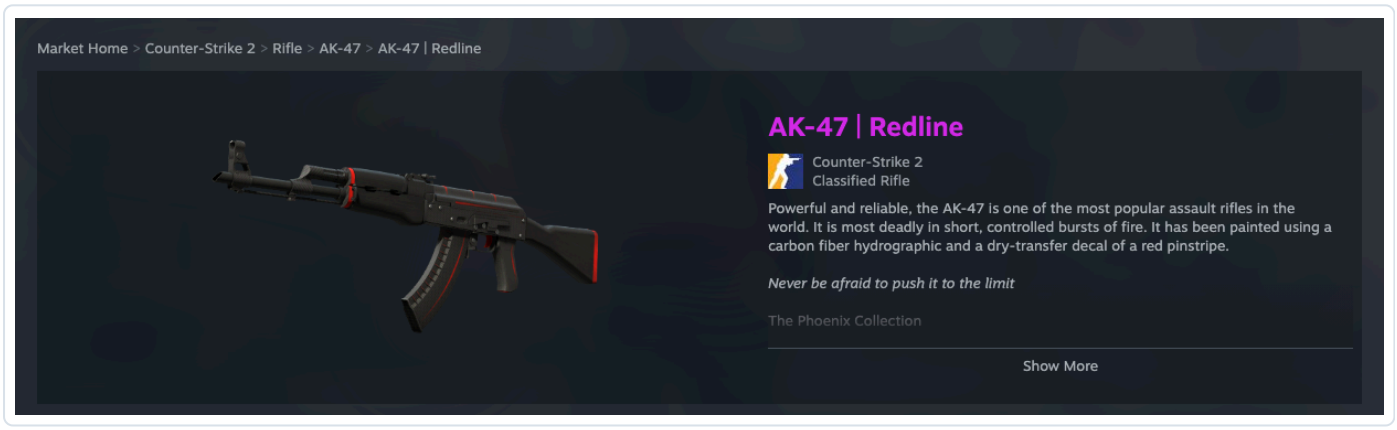
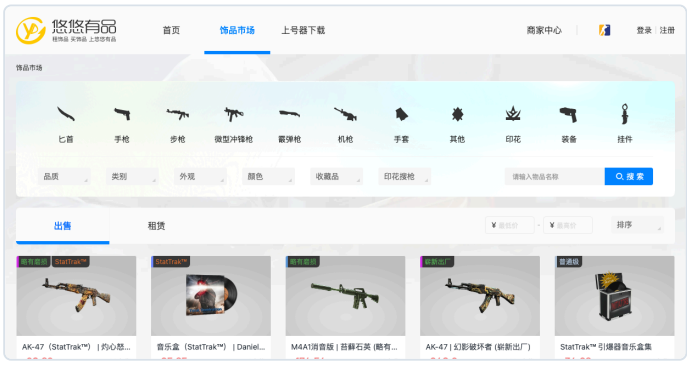


Figure 2. Steam Community Market listing for AK-47 | Redline (Field-Tested), English UI with a localized HKD price strip. The USD price used in Figure 1 comes from the Steam Market API; public page, accessed 2026-11-07.



BUFF163 · official fee announcement
Seller fee cut from 2.5% to 1.5%; withdrawal fee 1%. Public announcement, accessed 2026-11-07.



YouPin898 · public market
CNY listings from the public market page. Seller fee 1% (SteamDB, verified 2026-07-01). Accessed 2026-11-07.

Figure 3. Centralized alternatives. BUFF publishes a 1.5% seller fee; YouPin's public market lists items in CNY. Screenshots show public pages only; trademarks remain with their owners; no account data is shown.

The screenshots are illustrative and may show localized currencies or promotional content. The numeric analysis uses the source-linked fee rates and the USD Steam Market API prices, not OCR from the images.

3.1 Roles and trust boundaries

Five roles participate: seller, buyer, arbiter, Relay, and the seller-local helper. Steam is the external delivery system. The buyer and seller use a React web client and MetaMask; the seller also runs a local helper that holds the Steam session and sends the trade offer. The Relay stores item metadata, authenticates wallets, pairs helpers, and holds the buyer Trade URL encrypted at rest. The contract holds escrow and is the only component that can move funds.

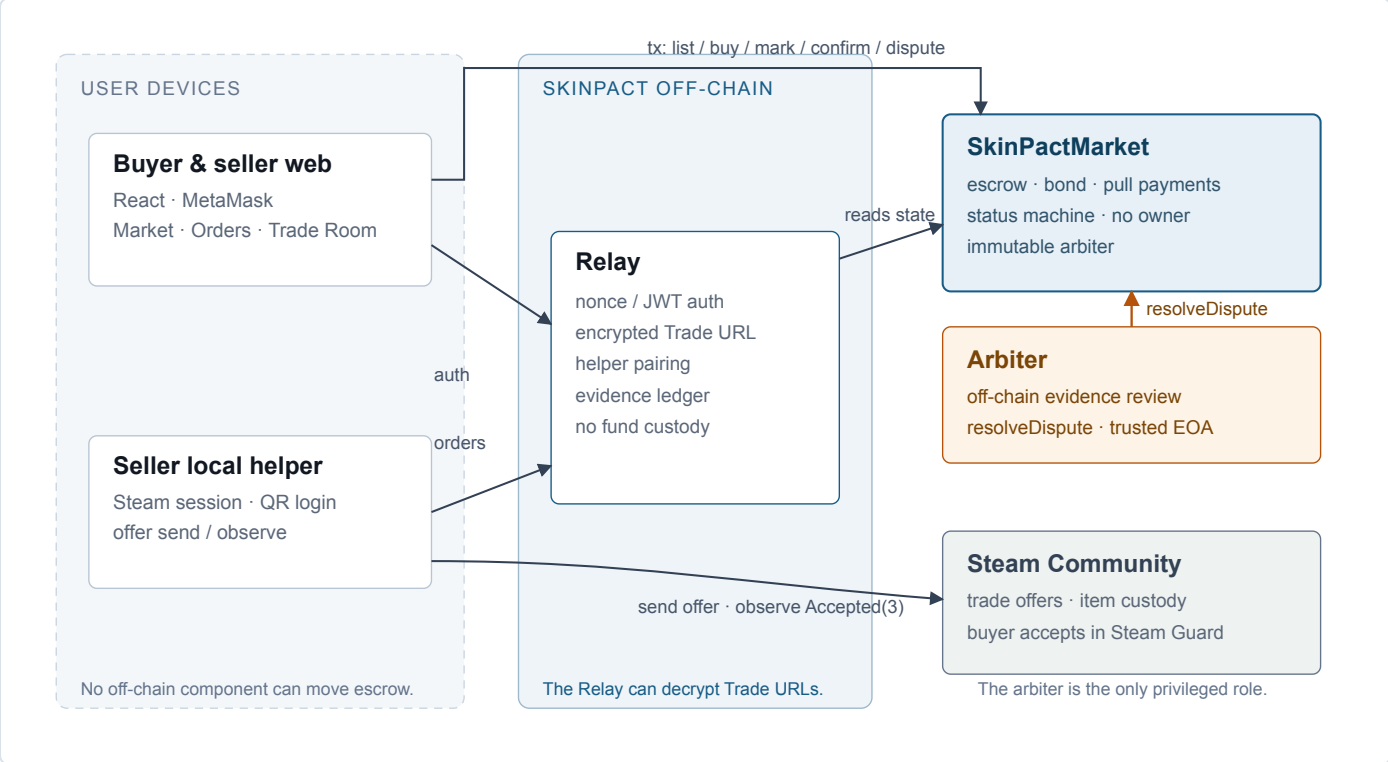


Figure 4. Trust boundaries. Solid arrows are instructions or data; dashed borders mark off-chain trust domains. The contract moves value; the Relay and helper coordinate delivery; Steam is authoritative for the item but invisible to the contract.

3.2 State machine

The contract has nine states. The happy path is `Active → Funded → OfferSent → ClaimPending → Completed`. The seller can cancel only while `Active`; the buyer can confirm from `Funded`, `OfferSent`, or `ClaimPending`; anyone can expire a `Funded` order after the offer deadline; and a buyer dispute from `ClaimPending` moves the order to `Disputed` before the challenge deadline. Once disputed, only the arbiter can settle.

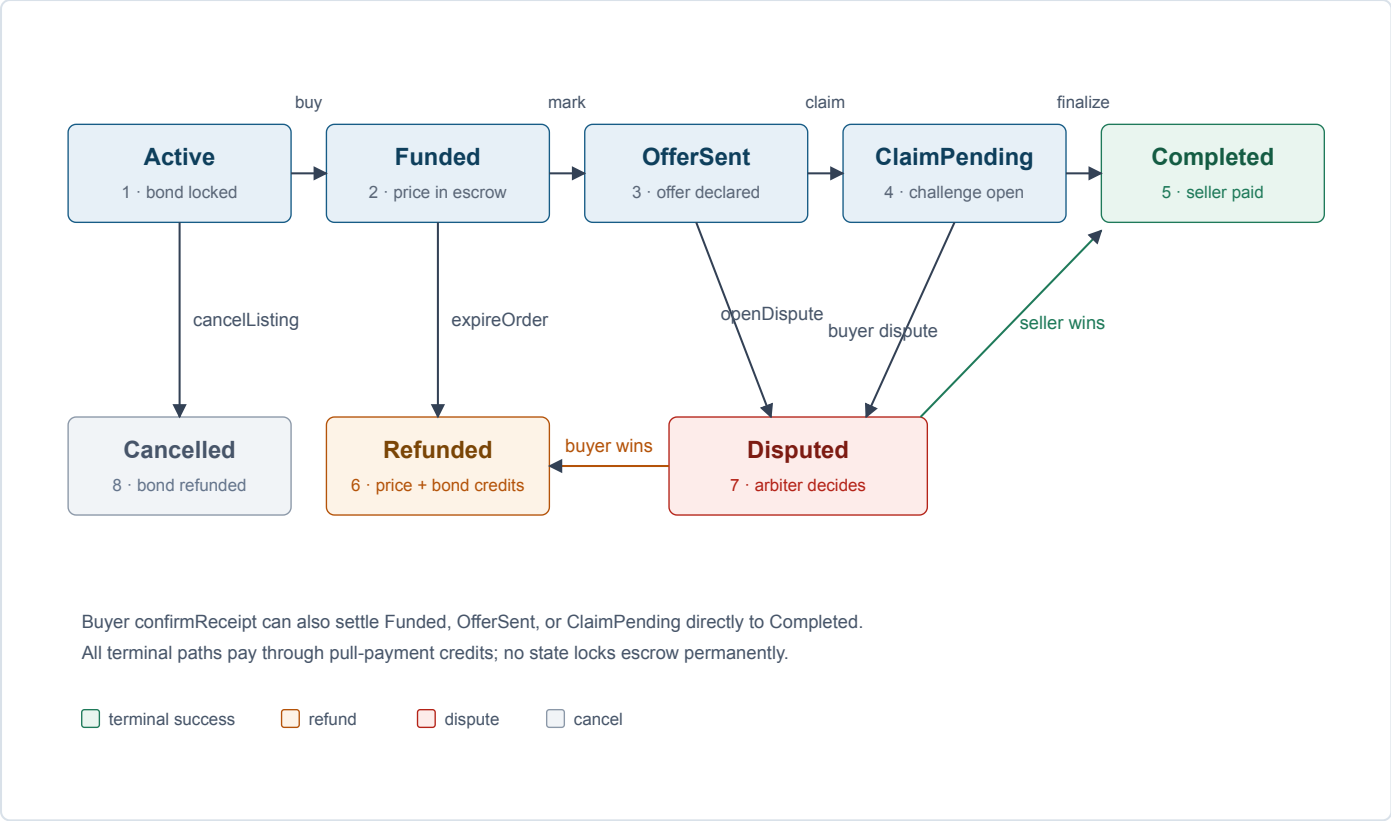


Figure 5. S2-mini state machine. The fast path is `claim → challenge → finalize`; the buyer fast path is `confirmReceipt`. Permissionless expiry and finalization provide liveness when the counterparty stops responding.

3.3 Escrow, bond, and pull payments

When a seller creates a listing, the bond is `max(price / 10, minBond)`. With a 0.01 test ETH price and a 0.001 test ETH minimum bond, the seller locks 0.001 and the buyer later locks 0.01. The contract credits balances rather than pushing ETH during settlement, and `withdraw()` is guarded by OpenZeppelin's `ReentrancyGuard`.[7] The design has no owner, no emergency withdrawal, and no upgrade path; the arbiter is immutable at construction.

3.4 Dispute and liveness

A dispute can be opened from `OfferSent` by either party before the delivery deadline, or by anyone after it. From `ClaimPending`, only the buyer can dispute before the challenge deadline. The arbiter can resolve a disputed listing in either direction, optionally awarding the seller bond to the buyer. Three permissionless paths keep the system live: `expireOrder` after the offer deadline, `finalizeClaim` after the challenge deadline, and `openDispute` after the delivery deadline. None of these verify Steam; they only bound how long escrow can wait.

04 Implementation

4.1 Contract and monorepo

SkinPact is a TypeScript monorepo with `shared`, `contracts`, `relay`, and `helper` workspaces. The contract (Solidity 0.8.24) is deployed and verified on Sepolia at `0x2Ffca056…460eF` with max price 0.1 test ETH, minimum bond 0.001 test ETH, a 600 s offer window, a 300 s challenge window, and a 3,600 s delivery window. The web client is React/Vite with MetaMask.

4.2 Off-chain coordination

The Relay authenticates wallets with a nonce and signed message, issues a one-hour JWT, and stores buyer Trade URLs with AES-256-GCM; URLs are revealed only to the funded listing's seller and deleted when the listing is terminal. The helper holds the seller's Steam session, sends the offer, observes the Steam state, and uploads acceptance evidence. The Relay can decrypt the Trade URL at runtime: a deliberate, disclosed trust boundary.

4.3 Evidence base

The implementation is supported by 67 automated tests (36 contract, 18 Relay, 12 helper, 1 shared), a 99-check local E2E flow (P1–P8, Steam mocked), and 22 Sepolia transactions. The completion smoke covers `claimAccepted`, `finalizeClaim`, `expireOrder`, and `withdraw`.

---

05 Experiment Methodology

E1 and E2 ask different questions but use the same discipline: define the question, instrument the environment, execute a reproducible procedure, normalize the raw data, and validate the claims against limitations. The local vs Sepolia gas discrepancy is treated as a finding, not smoothed away.

Measurement conventions. Local gas is measured on a fresh in-process Hardhat chain. Setup transactions are excluded; only the target operation's receipt is recorded. Local transactions use a fixed 1 gwei reporting price so the fee column is deterministic; this is a reporting convention, not a market price. Sepolia gas comes from real receipts. The local and Sepolia numbers are never summed.

Assumptions. The economic illustration assumes $3,000 per ETH and gas prices of 1, 10, and 50 gwei. Test ETH has no real value. The observed Sepolia gas price during the runs was 16–19 wei, which is an idle-testnet artifact and is not used for the economic conclusion. The 1% / 2.5% / 5% fee tiers are sensitivity inputs; the competitor rates are sourced separately.

---

06 E1 — Gas, Fees, and Break-even

6.1 Method

E1 measures the eleven state-changing operations defined in the S2-mini contract: `createListing`, `buy`, `markOfferSent`, `confirmReceipt`, `claimAccepted`, `finalizeClaim`, `expireOrder`, `cancelListing`, `openDispute`, `resolveDispute`, and `withdraw`. The scenario is a 0.01 test ETH listing with a 0.001 bond, matching the deployment configuration. Local measurements ran on the in-process Hardhat network; Sepolia measurements combine the original 2026-11-06 smoke with a 2026-11-07 completion smoke that waited through the real 300 s challenge window and 600 s offer window.

> A METHODOLOGICAL FINDING
>
> During the Sepolia runs, the network exhibited **Amsterdam-era gas rules** (state-creation repricing consistent with EIP-8037/8038, and the EIP-7708 ETH-transfer log from `0xffff…fffe`), while Hardhat 2.29.1 defaulted to **Osaka**. [4][5][6] The same operation can therefore differ by 2.6–4×. The report presents both columns and never mixes them.

6.2 Gas results

Table 1 reports gas used per operation on both environments. The four rows highlighted in blue are the happy path. Sepolia's state-creating operations are substantially more expensive than local Hardhat's; `expireOrder` and `withdraw` are close to local because they do not create as many new storage slots.

TABLE 1 · GAS USED PER OPERATION (HAPPY-PATH ROWS HIGHLIGHTED)

OPERATION	LOCAL OSAKA	SEPOLIA AMSTERDAM	RATIO
createListing	175,001	709,721	4.06×
buy	57,394	152,614	2.66×
markOfferSent	77,952	255,092	3.27×
confirmReceipt	64,161	55,845	0.87×
claimAccepted	55,698	144,830	2.60×
finalizeClaim	44,549	151,253	3.40×
expireOrder	68,820	67,704	0.98×
cancelListing	42,645	51,429	1.21×
openDispute	79,966	257,106	3.22×
resolveDispute	45,958	152,662	3.32×
withdraw	32,399	43,004	1.33×

Local: Hardhat 2.29.1, Osaka default, target-tx gas only, fixed 1 gwei reporting price. Sepolia: receipt gasUsed, 0.01 test ETH price, 0.001 bond. Ratios are Sepolia ÷ local; values below 1 mean Sepolia was cheaper.

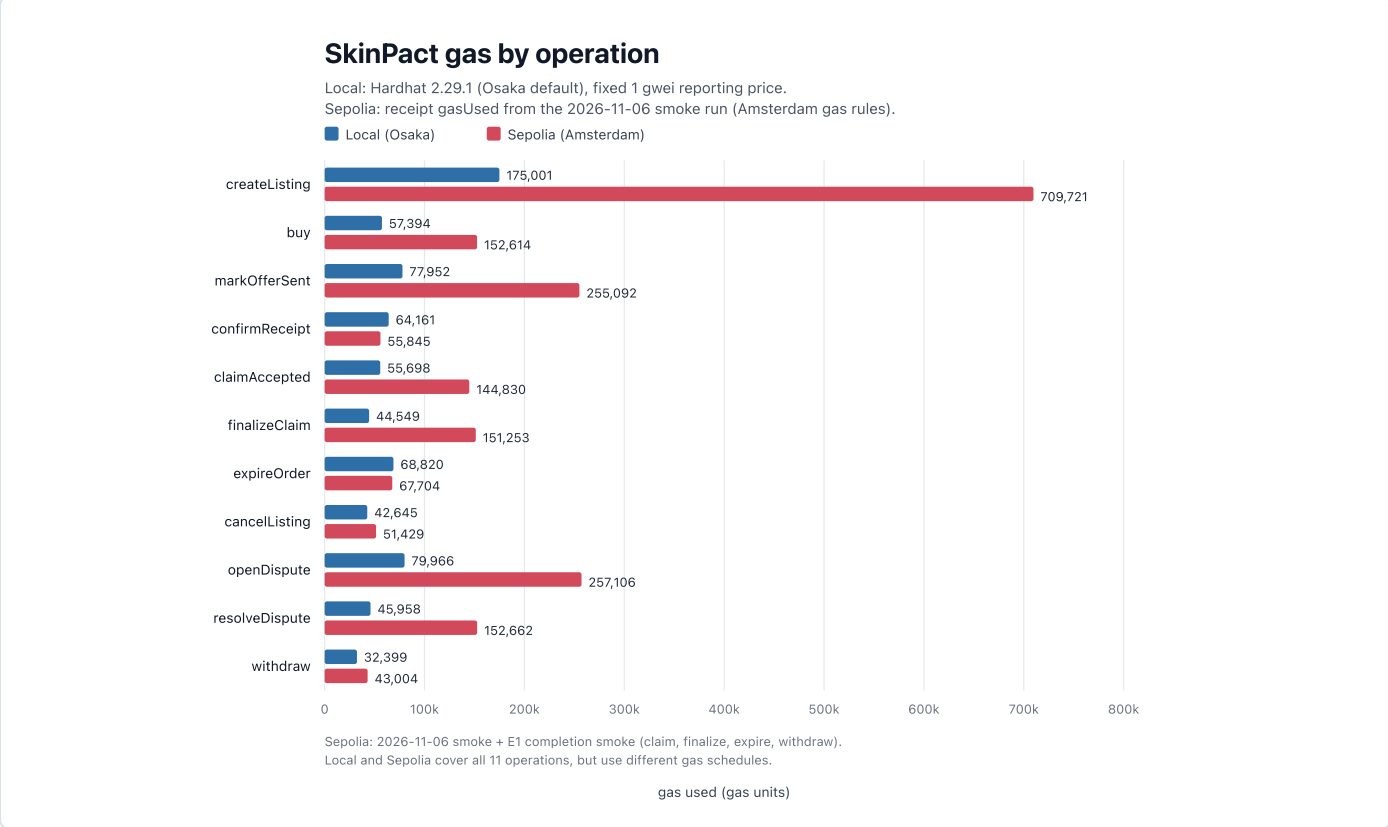


Figure 6. Gas by operation. Sepolia state creation dominates `createListing`, `markOfferSent`, `openDispute`, and claim resolution; `expireOrder` and `withdraw` are close across environments. Source: `experiments/e1/`.

6.3 Fee comparison

The analysis uses two kinds of numbers. The 1% / 2.5% / 5% tiers are hypothetical sensitivity inputs; they are not claims about a specific competitor. The competitor rates in Table 2 are sourced and dated. BUFF's official announcement is authoritative for 1.5%, although third-party trackers still display 2.5–3%. The discrepancy is disclosed rather than silently resolved.

TABLE 2 · SELLER FEE SOURCES

PLATFORM	SELLER FEE	BUYER FEE	SOURCE AND DATE	NOTE
Steam Community Market (CS2)	15%	0%	SteamDB, accessed 2026-11-07	5% Steam + 10% CS2 game fee
BUFF163	1.5%	0%	Official announcement, accessed 2026-11-07	Cut from 2.5% to 1.5% (effective 4-14); withdrawal 1%
YouPin898	1%	0%	SteamDB, last verified 2026-07-01	Seller fee only
Assumed tiers	1% / 2.5% / 5%	0%	Analysis assumption	Sensitivity inputs, not competitor claims

6.4 Break-even

Break-even item price is the gas cost of a successful trade divided by the fee rate. The happy path is `createListing + buy + markOfferSent + confirmReceipt`; `withdraw` is a post-settlement payout and is excluded from the sum, so the numbers below are a lower bound on total cost. At 10 gwei and $3,000/ETH, the Sepolia happy path costs about **$35.20** and the local Osaka path about **$11.24**; the Sepolia break-even prices are **$3,520 / $1,408 / $704** for 1% / 2.5% / 5%.

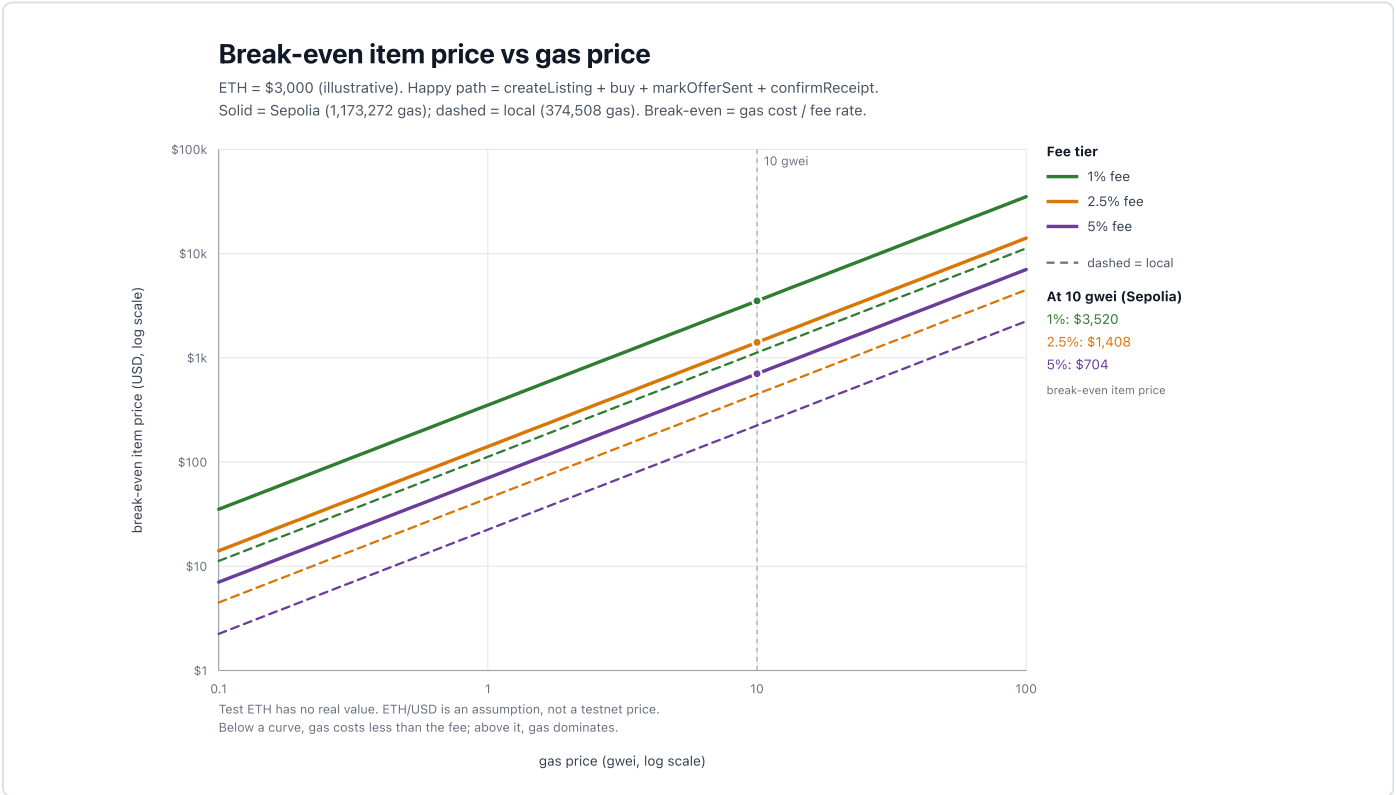


Figure 7. Break-even item price vs gas price. Solid lines are Sepolia; dashed lines are local Osaka. At 10 gwei, the Sepolia break-even prices are $3,520 / $1,408 / $704 for 1% / 2.5% / 5%. Below a curve, gas costs less than the fee; above it, gas dominates.

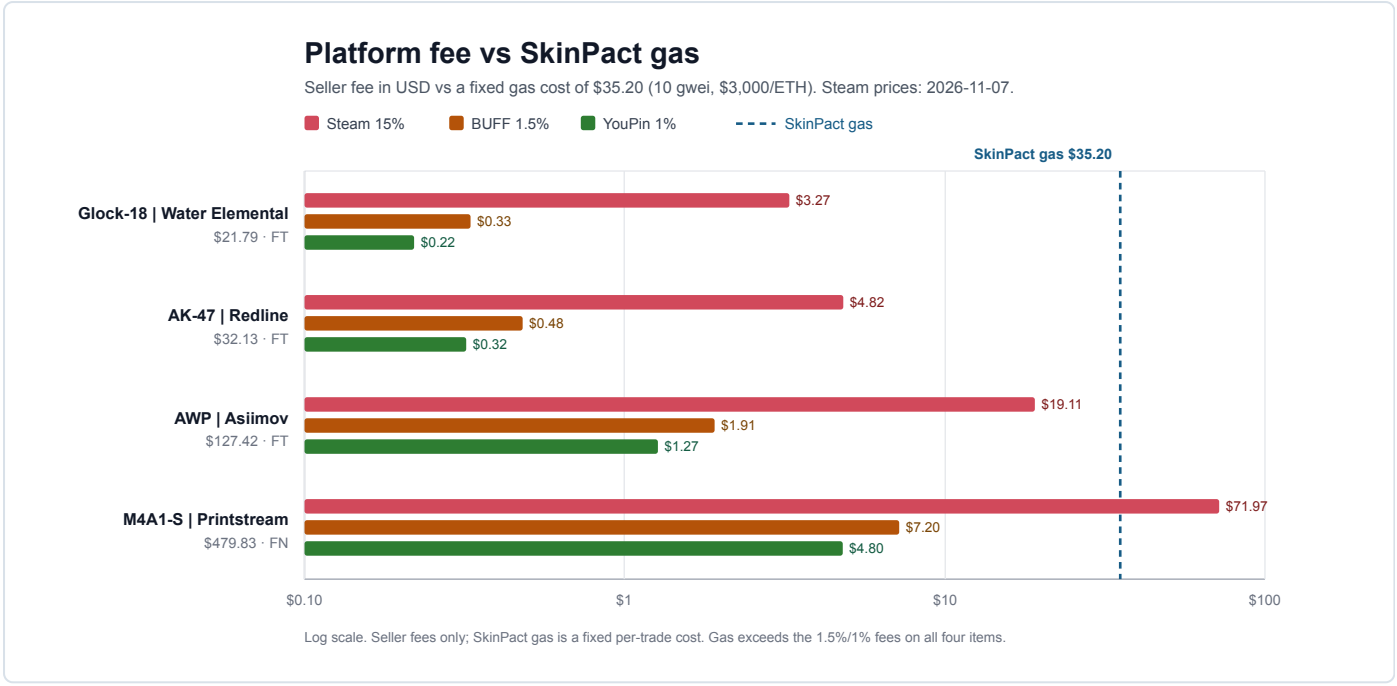


Figure 8. Platform fee vs SkinPact gas on the four items from Figure 1. Gas is fixed at $35.20 (10 gwei, $3,000/ETH); seller fees scale with price. Gas exceeds the 1.5%/1% fees on all four items, and exceeds the 15% Steam fee on the three lower-priced items (Glock-18, AK-47, AWP). Source: Steam Market prices, 2026-11-07; fee rates from Table 2.

6.5 Interpretation

Figure 8 makes the fixed-cost problem concrete. On the $21.79 Glock and the $32.13 AK-47, gas is roughly 7–11× the Steam fee; on the $479.83 M4A1-S, gas ($35.20) is below Steam's $71.97 fee but still above BUFF's $7.20 and YouPin's $4.80. L1 escrow therefore does not undercut the 1–1.5% centralized markets at these price points; its case rests on custody and dispute design, not on transaction cost.

For cheap CS2 skins, the fixed L1 cost dominates. At a 1% fee, an item must be worth more than roughly **$3,520** before gas is cheaper than the fee; at 2.5%, roughly **$1,408**; at 5%, roughly **$704**. The local Osaka numbers are lower but are not the deployment environment. The honest conclusion is that **a zero platform fee is not a zero cost**. The design is more attractive on an L2 or with a cheaper execution environment, or for higher-priced items. The observed Sepolia fees during the runs (16–19 wei; 70,700,971 wei across the original and completion target transactions) are an idle-testnet artifact and are not representative.

> THREATS TO VALIDITY
>
> Local and Sepolia gas schedules differ (Osaka vs Amsterdam); the numbers are reported side by side and are not mixed. The economic conclusion depends on the $3,000 ETH assumption and the 1/10/50 gwei scenarios. The Sepolia smoke is a small number of runs, and the completion smoke's setup transactions are excluded from the CSV. The happy-path sum excludes withdrawal, making the break-even figures a lower bound.

6.6 Why four on-chain transactions?

The current version deliberately keeps every state transition on-chain: `createListing` locks the bond and writes the listing, `buy` funds escrow, `markOfferSent` records the seller's declaration, and `confirmReceipt` settles. This maximizes on-chain order-state auditability: the contract, not a server, holds the authoritative state, and anyone can reconstruct the path. The cost is four transactions: 1,173,272 gas ≈ $35.20 at 10 gwei and $3,000/ETH. `markOfferSent` is 255,092 gas (22%) and moves no funds; `createListing` is 709,721 gas (60%) and includes the bond—the two obvious v2 candidates.

A v2 would use an EIP-712 signed listing off-chain, a reusable bond vault, and an off-chain signed mark attestation; only buyer funding (`buy`) and settlement (`confirmReceipt`, or `claimAccepted` plus `finalizeClaim`) remain on-chain. At the same assumptions, funding plus confirmation is 208,459 gas ≈ **$6.25** (about 82% less) plus the bond and optional withdrawal; the claim path is 448,697 gas ≈ **$13.46**. NFT order books (Seaport, 0x) keep signed orders off-chain and settle only fulfillment;[15][16] centralized CS2 markets (Skinport, BUFF, YouPin) use an internal ledger and Steam bots, with no chain gas, in exchange for fees and custody.[17][18] The trade-off is auditability versus an off-chain order book; a trust-minimized escrow still needs at least fund and settle, and a relayer/paymaster or L2 can hide or lower the fee but cannot make it free.

---

07 E2 — Security and Trust Boundaries

7.1 Threat model

E2 asks whether the contract, Relay, and helper can resist unauthorized calls, reentrancy, state bypasses, fake claims, and Trade URL leakage — and which trust assumptions remain. The threat model covers malicious buyers, sellers, arbiters, Relay operators, helper operators, local machine attackers, and network attackers. Assets include escrowed price and bond, the CS2 item, buyer Trade URLs, seller Steam sessions, evidence, and the Relay's encryption and JWT secrets. The full model contains 42 scenarios; the most important are summarized in Table 3.

TABLE 3 · SELECTED THREATS AND THEIR TREATMENT

ID	THREAT	MITIGATION	RESIDUAL
T-01	Unauthorized party calls seller/buyer/arbiter functions	Role checks; 36 contract tests	None found
T-04	Double settlement or replay	Terminal-state guards; status machine	None found
T-11	Fake `claimAccepted`	Buyer dispute; arbiter review	Steam unverifiable (F-01)
T-17	Trade URL leaks via API/DB/logs	AES-256-GCM; seller-only; cleanup; redaction	Relay can decrypt (F-03)
T-20	Login signature replay	One-time nonce; 5-minute TTL	None found
T-25	DNS rebinding against helper API	Loopback host check; origin allowlist	Local malware (F-13)

7.2 Evidence pipeline

The 42-scenario model drove 67 automated tests, static analysis, and coverage; the surviving issues are recorded as 17 findings, each with severity, evidence, and residual risk, and summarized in the trust table.

7.3 Results

All 67 automated tests pass. The local E2E flow passes 99 checks across P1–P8. Slither 0.11.6 reports **zero High/Medium** findings and five informational instances: four timestamp comparisons in deadline logic and one low-level call in `withdraw`. Coverage is **100% of statements, functions, and lines** and **87.5% of branches**.

7.4 Findings

The findings are reported as trust-boundary and design risks, not as exploitable code vulnerabilities. The severity distribution is 1 high-impact accepted trust boundary (F-03), 3 medium, 8 low, and 5 informational; there are no

critical or high code-vulnerability findings. The four findings below drive the security narrative. F-04 (buyer dispute freeze) and F-05 (seller marks without sending) are lower-severity griefing paths documented in the repository.

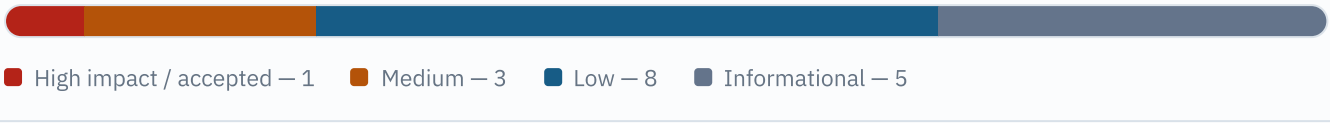


TABLE 4 · KEY FINDINGS

ID	FINDING	SEVERITY	EVIDENCE	RESIDUAL RISK
F-01	Steam delivery cannot be verified on-chain	MEDIUM	Claim path; E2E P7; threat model T-11	Arbiter reviews off-chain evidence
F-02	Arbiter is a single immutable EOA	MEDIUM	Contract design; trust table	Key loss or abuse; no rotation
F-03	Buyer Trade URL is a bearer secret the Relay can decrypt	HIGH IMPACT / ACCEPTED	Relay tests; E2E P4	Relay host compromise; user must accept offer
F-06	Buyer-first Accept race cannot be proven on-chain	MEDIUM	Workflow analysis; manual Steam check	Procedural constraint; off-chain evidence

7.5 Trust table

The trust table is the complement to the findings: it states what each component can do unilaterally. The contract has no owner and no upgrade path; the arbiter is privileged only on Disputed listings; the Relay can decrypt Trade URLs but cannot move escrow; the helper can observe Steam but cannot sign for the seller; Steam is authoritative for the item but invisible to the contract.

TABLE 5 · TRUST TABLE (SUMMARY)

COMPONENT	TRUSTED FOR	CAN UNILATERALLY	CANNOT	ENFORCED BY
SkinPactMarket	Correct state and accounting	Move escrow only through coded paths	Upgrade, add an owner, or withdraw arbitrarily	Immutable bytecode; no owner
Arbiter	Fair interpretation of evidence	Resolve any Disputed listing	Touch non-disputed states; resolve twice	`NotArbiter`; `NotDisputed`
Relay	Auth, URL vault, evidence bookkeeping	Decrypt Trade URLs at runtime	Move escrow; reveal URL to a non-seller	JWT/helper tokens; AES-256-GCM; on-chain role checks
Helper	Truthful Steam observation	Send offers; report evidence	Sign for the seller; claim funds	Seller runs it; Relay scopes by seller; Steam is source of truth
Steam	Item custody and transfer	Delay, deny, or reverse offers	Move on-chain escrow	None; evidence is observational

7.6 Discussion

The strongest result is negative: within the tested scope, there is no authorization, reentrancy, double-settlement, or Trade URL access-control defect. The contract's state machine and pull-payment accounting held under mixed-state invariants; the Relay kept the raw Trade URL out of API payloads, database rows, and reports; and the helper's loopback API rejected DNS-rebinding hosts and disallowed origins. The residual risk is trust, not a

missing check: Steam cannot be verified, the arbiter is a single key, and the Relay can decrypt the buyer's bearer URL. Those are disclosed constraints, not hidden vulnerabilities.

> WHAT THIS DOES NOT PROVE
>
> Slither is a static analyzer, not a formal verification or a third-party audit. Coverage measures executed code, not correctness. The E2E Steam transport is mocked; the real-Steam acceptance was a manual exit check. The threat model covers the stated scope, not every deployment or adversarial environment.

08 Usability

A formal usability study was not conducted. The analysis focuses on cost and security, and the remaining time was allocated to the deliverable pipeline. Usability evidence is therefore limited to the manual local E2E flow and the manual real-Steam exit check: the seller scans a QR code, pairs the helper, lists an item; the buyer saves an account, funds escrow, and accepts the offer in Steam Guard; the seller marks the offer and the buyer confirms. The flow is functional but not validated with independent users.

If a usability study is added, the intended protocol is a 2–3 reviewer Nielsen heuristic rather than a user study: reviewers walk the four tasks above, record completion, friction, and severity, and the report labels the result explicitly as a heuristic evaluation. No fabricated SEQ/SUS scores are presented here.

09 Security and Limitations

The following constraints are part of the contribution, not fine print. They should be read alongside the positive results.

TABLE 6 · RESIDUAL RISKS AND REQUIRED DISCLOSURES

LIMITATION	IMPACT	STATUS
Steam delivery is off-chain and unverifiable	False claims require arbitration; no on-chain proof	Disclosed (F-01)
Arbiter is a single immutable EOA	Key loss disables disputes; abuse can misdirect funds	Disclosed (F-02)
Trade URL is a bearer secret; Relay can decrypt	Relay compromise leaks active URLs; user must still accept	Disclosed (F-03)
No formal usability study	No user-level evidence for the helper/Steam flow	Disclosed (§8)
Test ETH has no value; mock Steam in E2E	Economic and delivery results are illustrative	Disclosed throughout
No third-party audit or formal verification	Static analysis and tests are not a security guarantee	Disclosed (§7)
L1 gas dominates low-priced trades	Break-even is high at 1% fees	Disclosed (E1)
Challenge notifications rely on UI polling	Buyer may miss a challenge window	Disclosed (F-07)

Testnet-only statement. SkinPact is a course prototype. Escrow uses Sepolia test ETH, which has no real value. CS2 items remain off-chain assets. The system is not intended for mainnet, real money, or production use.

Mock statement. The automated local E2E uses a mocked Steam transport; the helper's offer and acceptance reports are simulated there. The real-Steam acceptance is a separate manual exit check and is not claimed as

automated evidence. The video and report must label real vs mock consistently.

10 Conclusion and Future Work

SkinPact shows that a small, auditable escrow state machine can coordinate a Steam delivery without custodial fund authority. The contract has no owner, no upgrade path, and no emergency withdrawal; the bond and pull-payment design return funds on every terminal path; the dispute path gives the parties a last resort when delivery is contested. E1 makes the cost visible: at 10 gwei and $3,000/ETH, a successful Sepolia trade costs about $35 in gas, and a 1% fee only breaks even above roughly $3,520. E2 makes the trust visible: no High/Medium static findings, no exploitable authorization or double-settlement defect in the tested scope, but Steam remains unverifiable, the arbiter is a single key, and the Relay can decrypt the buyer's Trade URL.

Future work should move in four directions: (1) an L2 or stablecoin settlement path so low-priced skins are economic; (2) a multi-signature or policy-bound arbiter with an evidence-read API and a documented chain of custody; (3) a key-management design for the Relay's Trade URL vault (KMS/HSM, minimized retention, helper-token revocation); and (4) a real usability study of the seller-helper and Steam-accept flow. None of these changes the core claim: the escrow is a coordination layer around an off-chain delivery rail, and its value depends on making both the cost and the trust explicit.

11 References

1. SteamDB. “Steam Market Review.” `https://steamdb.com/en/markets/steam` (accessed 2026-11-07). Seller fee 15% = 5% Steam transaction fee + 10% CS2 game fee; buyer fee 0%.
2. BUFF163. “BUFF手续费下调公告” (announcement 87397). `https://buff.163.com/news/87397` (accessed 2026-11-07). Seller fee cut from 2.5% to 1.5%; withdrawal fee 1%.
3. SteamDB. “YouPin Review.” `https://steamdb.com/en/markets/youpin` (last verified 2026-07-01; accessed 2026-11-07). Seller fee 1%, buyer fee 0%.
4. Ethereum Improvement Proposals. “EIP-8037: State Creation Gas Cost Increase” and “EIP-8038: State-Access Gas Cost Update.” `https://eips.sh/eip/8037` · `https://eips.sh/eip/8038` (accessed 2026-11-07).
5. Hardhat. “Amsterdam hardfork support.” `https://hardhat.org/docs/reference/amsterdam-support` (accessed 2026-11-07).
6. EIP-7708: ETH transfers emit a log. `https://eips.sh/eip/7708` (accessed 2026-11-07).
7. OpenZeppelin. “ReentrancyGuard.” `https://docs.openzeppelin.com/contracts/5.x/api/utils#ReentrancyGuard` (accessed 2026-11-07).
8. Hardhat. `https://hardhat.org` (accessed 2026-11-07).
9. Crytic. “Slither.” `https://github.com/crytic/slither` (accessed 2026-11-07).
10. solidity-coverage. `https://github.com/sc-forks/solidity-coverage` (accessed 2026-11-07).
11. ethers.js v6 documentation. `https://docs.ethers.org/v6/` (accessed 2026-11-07).
12. MetaMask developer documentation. `https://docs.metamask.io` (accessed 2026-11-07).
13. SkinPact repository. `https://github.com/identity411/dapps` (commit `6d8ffa0`; accessed 2026-11-07).
14. Sepolia Etherscan. SkinPactMarket verified contract. `https://sepolia.etherscan.io/address/0x2Ffca05611801F532Afc6135b56baBEB0D7460eF#code` (accessed 2026-11-07).

15. OpenSea. “Introducing Seaport Protocol.” https://blog-v3.opensea.io/articles/introducing-seaport-protocol (accessed 2026-11-07). EIP-712 signed orders, fulfillment, batching.
16. 0x Protocol: off-chain order relay and on-chain settlement. https://www.gate.com/learn/articles/how-does-0x-protocol-work (accessed 2026-11-07).
17. SteamDB. “Skinport Review.” https://steamdb.com/en/markets/skinport (verified 2026-07-02; accessed 2026-11-07). Seller fee 8% standard; reduced tiers for high-value/private listings.
18. Skinport. “Is Skinport Safe and Secure?” https://skinport.com/blog/is-skinport-safe-and-secure (accessed 2026-11-07). Custodial bot flow; no blockchain settlement.

A Appendix A — Sepolia Evidence

The contract is deployed and verified on Sepolia. The completion smoke used the same verified contract and waited through the real windows; no new contract was deployed for E1.

```
DEPLOYMENT AND COMPLETION EVIDENCE

contract 0x2Ffca05611801F532Afc6135b56baBEB0D7460eF · Etherscan Exact Match
deploy 0xa13f…04e6 · block 12,077,649 · maxPrice 0.1 ETH, minBond 0.001 ETH, 600/300/3600 s windows
claimAccepted 0x9c46…ab55 · 144,830 gas · finalizeClaim 0x2378…b743 · 151,253 gas
expireOrder 0xb107…db3e · 67,704 gas · withdraw 0x5054…ee70 · 43,004 gas
```

Full hashes and setup txs: `experiments/e1/sepolia-smoke.json` and `sepolia-smoke-missing.json`.

Reproducibility

```
COMMANDS (REPOSITORY ROOT)

npm test && npm run e2e:local && npm run typecheck && npm run build
npm run e1:gas && npm run e1:report
cd contracts && npx hardhat coverage
slither + environment versions: experiments/e2/README.md
```